

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

Preparation of the 11th Consultation

Combating discrimination in education

Eleventh consultation of Member States on the application of the Convention and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960) (2024-2025)

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

1. Introduction

The Convention against Discrimination in Education (“the Convention”) and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (“the Recommendation”), adopted by UNESCO’s General Conference in 1960, are aligned with UNESCO’s constitutional mandate to “advance the ideal of equality of educational opportunities without regard to race, sex or any distinctions, economic or social”. The Convention is the first legally binding international instrument focused on the **right to education** and the only one exclusively dedicated to it.

The right to education is one of the key principles underpinning the Education 2030 agenda and Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4) adopted by the international community in 2015. SDG 4 seeks to ensure the full enjoyment of the right to education as fundamental to achieving sustainable development. Its scope captures the multidimensional nature of the right to education.

Representing a powerful tool to advance SDG 4 by ensuring effective articulation between normative and operational work, the Convention has been recognized as a cornerstone of Education 2030 agenda.

The present Guidelines are intended to assist Member States in the preparation of country reports on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation in the context of the 11th consultation.

2. Scope of the Consultation

Considering the Education 2030 agenda, the monitoring of the Convention and the Recommendation is of crucial importance to ensure an education that is truly inclusive for all and to counter persistent inequalities in access, participation and learning outcomes at all levels, particularly for the most vulnerable groups. This is particularly true under the current context in which countries are making efforts to recover from the learning disruption caused by the COVID-19 pandemic. Concrete measures taken by countries in accordance with their legal obligations under these instruments contribute to implementing the Education 2030 agenda.

As the scope and content of the legal obligations under the right to education are aligned with the 10 targets of SDG 4, efforts are being made to ensure that the components of the targets are included in the guidelines and that these guidelines serve as a valuable contribution to monitoring progress towards SDG 4 targets.

Beyond SDG 4, the Convention is also closely aligned with the normative content on the right to education of other international human rights instruments such as the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966), Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of

Discrimination against Women (1979), the Convention on the Rights of the Child (1989) and the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (2006).

In addition, this Consultation is an opportunity to inform the ongoing **UNESCO Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education within a lifelong learning perspective**¹ (launched in December 2021). The Initiative investigates how the right to education could be reinforced placing it within a lifelong learning perspective and in light of the new demands being placed on education. This Initiative builds on the **Report from the International Commission on the Futures of Education**², which suggests to broaden our understanding of the right to education to clearly apply it to all ages and across all times and spaces. The initiative is also in-line with the **Vision Statement of the United Nations Secretary General on Transforming Education**³, and the **Report on the 2022 Transforming Education Summit**⁴ which call for the transformation of education systems to 'include everyone, regardless of circumstance, context or background'. The Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education aims to open a collaborative and participatory discussion about the international framework to ensure the effective enforcement of the right to education and learning throughout life for all. Finally, the Initiative builds on recent inter-governmental dialogues, including the Marrakech Framework for Action for Adult Learning and Education⁵ and the Tashkent Declaration on Early Childhood Care and Education.⁶

It is also important to note that previous consultations on the Convention and Recommendation revealed that countries now understand the right to education in an extended manner. The 11th consultation builds on the findings of the previous national reports to include various areas that have direct repercussions on the right to education such as, for instance, digital learning, climate considerations, lifelong learning entitlement, and the role of non-state actors in education.

3. Reporting obligations

There are differences in the legal nature of the obligations under the Convention, as distinguished from those under the Recommendation. The Convention has binding force and the States Parties are under the obligation to incorporate its provisions into their domestic frameworks. The Recommendation, non-binding in nature, has political and moral force. Its adoption sought to take into account the difficulties that certain States might experience in ratifying the Convention, in particular with respect to their federal structure.

Bearing in mind the differences in legal scope inherent to the nature of these two categories of instruments, the content of the Recommendation is identical to that of the Convention. Member States are expected to give effect to it in national legislation and education policies.

The reporting obligation under the provisions of Article VII of the Convention and of the Recommendation is the same. Article VIII of UNESCO's Constitution states that "*Each Member State shall submit to the Organization, at such times and in such manner as shall be determined by the General Conference, reports on the laws, regulations and statistics relating to its educational, scientific and cultural institutions and activities, and on the action taken upon the recommendations and conventions referred to in Article IV, paragraph 4*". Therefore, even if a country is not a State Party to the Convention, it needs to submit a report on the implementation of the Recommendation, which means that **all UNESCO Member States are expected to submit a national report** on the implementation of these instruments in the context of monitoring consultations.

¹ <https://www.unesco.org/en/right-education/evolving>

² <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379707>

³ https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/2022/09/sg_vision_statement_on_transforming_education.pdf

⁴ https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/report_on_the_2022_transforming_education_summit.pdf

⁵ Marrakech Framework for Action | Institute for Lifelong Learning (unesco.org)

⁶ [Tashkent-declaration-ecce-2022.pdf \(unesco.org\)](#)

4. Participation in consultations

The reporting period for the 11th consultation on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation covers four years (2021-2024).

The Futures of Education Report calls for a new social contract for education, which requires to understand education as a common good and a shared societal endeavour. To ensure this, extensive consultations involving a broad range of stakeholders is needed. The reporting process therefore needs to be **participatory**. This includes ensuring cooperation between ministries of education and other ministries dealing with aspects of the right to education as well as consulting social partners and **civil society organizations** and other relevant bodies.

The preparation of national reports provides a **good opportunity** for Member States to assess the implementation of the right to education in their country, identify specific challenges, build constructive dialogue with other actors involved in this field and share good practices.

In the preparation of reports, Member States are encouraged to provide **substantive and relevant information in a concise manner**. In addition to a description of the constitutional, legislative, administrative, and policy framework established for the implementation of the provisions guaranteed by the instruments, the information supplied by Member States should demonstrate how legal norms and practices comply with the Convention and the Recommendation.

Relevant information supplied for other reporting instances may be reproduced or referred to with precise indication as to its retrieval. Similarly, hyperlinks to any useful documents or relevant legal and policy texts are most welcome and texts can also be added in the annex.

Country reports submitted for previous consultations can be found on the **Observatory on the right to education**⁷ in the monitoring section of the country profile. The information provided in the reports are valuable both for the Observatory on the right to education as well as for **HerAtlas**⁸, the online monitoring tool for girls' and women's right to education. Information and data regarding countries' education systems are also available through the UNESCO Institute for Statistics database⁹. Beyond monitoring purposes, the consultation findings and reports inform broader work - serving for knowledge generation, advocacy, and technical cooperation.

5. Modalities and structure

The Guidelines are structured around three chapters:

- The **first chapter** covers general information on adherence to the Convention.
- The **second chapter** aims to gather information on the implementation of the Convention and Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4. As the most extensive part of the Guidelines, this chapter covers: inclusion and non-discrimination in education (section 1), all levels and forms of education (section 2), quality education provision and learning environment (section 3) and finally, strengthening governance systems (section 4).
- The **third chapter** seeks to obtain information on the methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments.

With a view to simplify the Guidelines while providing necessary substantive information to assist Member States in the preparation of responses, through a participatory process, **two types of guidance** are provided:

⁷ <http://www.unesco.org/education/edurights/index.php?action=home&lng=en>

⁸ <https://en.unesco.org/education/girls-women-rights>

⁹ [UIS Statistics \(unesco.org\)](https://uis.unesco.org)

- (1) Open-ended and closed-ended questions to be directly filled in by Member States. Please note that multiple answers may be provided where relevant.
- (2) Additional information aimed at guiding Members States to structure and detail their responses to the open-ended questions (including remarks on how to respond efficiently to the questions raised). These elements are presented in italics.

GENERAL INFORMATION:

Country name: **Bahrain**

Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report: **Ministry of Education**

Name of contact person: **Dr. Shaikha Mufeez**

Email and telephone number of contact person: shaikha_b12@moe.gov.bh

0097336188855

I. Ratification and applicability of the Convention against Discrimination in Education¹⁰

- Is your country a State Party to the Convention?

☐ Yes

☒ No: Does your country plan to ratify this instrument?

☒ Yes: Please indicate the stage of ratification process reached by your country and whether assistance is needed:

☒ There is interest but no concrete action has been taken

☐ The ratification process has been initiated

☐ The ratification process is close to completion

- Please briefly explain the steps that have been taken and timeline when relevant, any difficulties encountered (legal, institutional, political or practical) in completing the ratification process. And how UNESCO can assist:

Recently, the Bahrain National Commission along with the authorities in the Ministry of Education of Bahrain held a meeting with UNESCO and The UNESCO Regional Office for the Gulf States and Yemen in Doha, to discuss the Right to Education and the implementation of the ratification process of the 1960 convention. The discussions aimed at seeking guidance and expertise from UNESCO to navigate the ratification process and address any challenges that may arise.

☐ No, not considering ratification. Please explain why:

- Is the Convention directly applicable in your country's domestic law?

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Have courts, tribunals and/or administrative authorities adjudicated on issues or violations regarding the right to education?¹¹

☐ No

☒ Yes: Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked?

☐ Yes ☒ No

- Please cite the case law and jurisprudence.

Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with respect to the right to education.

Education law 27 for year 2005: This law is related to education, one of the rights guaranteed by the Kingdom to all citizens. It covers its most important objectives and principles, the bodies responsible for the educational system and its most important tasks, the ages where education is compulsory, the penalty for depriving children of their right to education, the role of the ministry in eliminating illiteracy, the most important basic materials for education, and the number of school days.

Article Six

Primary Education is a right for children who attain the age of six at the beginning of the academic year. The Kingdom is committed to providing education to them, and parents or guardians are obligated to implement it over a period of at least nine academic years. The Minister shall issue the necessary decisions to organise and implement compulsory education for parents and guardians. Children below Compulsory Schooling Age may be admitted to Primary Education schools which have available places, subject to the rules and regulations issued in a decision of the Minister.

Article Eight

The parent or guardian of a child shall be punished by a fine not exceeding one hundred dinars if he causes the child who has attained the Compulsory Schooling Age to fail to have access to education or to quit, without an acceptable excuse, from attending School for a period of ten consecutive or separate days during the academic year. A criminal lawsuit shall not be initiated in both cases except at the request of the Ministry and after it has warned the violator by a certified letter accompanied by acknowledgement of the receipt.

II. Information on the implementation of the Convention or Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4)

1. Towards an inclusive non-discriminatory education system

For reference: This section relates to the main purpose of the Convention/Recommendation that is to underscore the state obligation to proscribe any form of discrimination in education while promoting equality

¹¹ Judicial mechanisms play an important role in enforcing the right to education by ensuring legal accountability and therefore contributing to the practical realization of the right to education.

of educational opportunity as laid out in Articles/Paragraphs 1(1), 2 and 3 of the Convention/Recommendation.

It further corresponds to the overall aspiration of SDG4 which aims to “**ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all**” by 2030. While it covers all the SDG4 targets, it also specifically covers SDG target 4.5.¹²

- Please indicate whether the rights and principles laid out in the Convention/Recommendation informed the elaboration of the education legal and/or policy framework:

☐ Yes ☒ No

- If yes, please provide reference:

The Kingdom of Bahrain did not sign the agreement, but it was keen to emphasize the state’s commitment to prohibiting all forms of discrimination in education and promoting equality at the level of learning opportunities, in line with the general ambition of Goal 4 of Sustainable Development to “ensure comprehensive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all.” by 2030, through:

➤ **Achieving parity between the various components of society in education:**

The Kingdom of Bahrain seeks to achieve quality education as one of the goals of sustainable development and to improve its outcomes. The Ministry of Education works permanently and periodically to review its educational system to enhance equal opportunities among the various components of society, specifically:

- **Parity between girls and boys in education:**

Basic education is free and compulsory. The enrollment rate in the basic and secondary levels for both sexes increased by 14%, which led to the elimination of illiteracy, while the enrollment rate in kindergarten reached more than 82%.

- **Various international reports, especially those issued by UNESCO, have shown that the Kingdom of Bahrain has achieved honorable results that can be summarized in:**

- A high enrollment rate in the primary stage.
- A high percentage of gender equality .
- Low drop out from the school’s rate.
- In this context, the Kingdom of Bahrain has been keen, since 2006, to establish a special section to follow up on the implementation of compulsory education for those of compulsory age (6-15 years), follow up on those who have dropped out of the same age group, and work to re-enroll them in education, in coordination with the Central Information Agency, Information Systems Department at the Ministry of Education.

- **Equality in vocational opportunities between boys and girls: through:**

¹² Which calls on states to “eliminate gender disparities in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”.

- Adopting the principle of inclusive education, which responds to the requirements of education for all, regardless of the actual preparations of learners, whether superior or limited, as well as the requirements of legislation related to human rights and the achievement of effective citizenship that achieves more development and more opportunities.
- A strategy of continuing education and lifelong education was adopted, in accordance with the philosophy of continuing education, to develop and modernize the various capabilities and skills of the Bahraini citizen, keeping pace with the latest global developments, and to achieve development, relying on various programs directed to all groups and levels, considering the needs of individuals and the labor market.

➤ **Education for people with special needs:**

The Kingdom of Bahrain has paid great attention to providing all educational opportunities for this social group as stated in the Education Law that stipulates in Article Five, First Paragraph, "Providing educational opportunities for every individual to develop his aptitudes, abilities, and skills to achieve self-actualization and develop his life and society." It was also mentioned in Paragraph (10) of the same Constitution that it is necessary to provide a variety of educational opportunities based on the diverse needs of individuals, caring for gifted and talented students, and enhancing their experiences, and caring for slow learners and people with special needs, and this can be demonstrated through:

- Ensuring all schools that receive this category are equipped with infrastructure and materials.
- Providing their own buses and providing trained and qualified human cadres to teach them.
- Providing them with different resources as supplies to support them within the school year, in addition to the support given from the teachers during the examination period.
- Integrating students with mild mental disability, down syndrome and autism who are capable of learning into the specialized classes within the governmental schools (primary and intermediate levels), and providing all the supporting devices that help them study with their regular student peers.
- On the other hand, students with educational problems such as (learning difficulties, marginal intelligence, slow learners, and ADHD) have specialized programs for primary and intermediate levels with different strategies to support these students to integrate within the regular classes in schools.
- For secondary level, students with special needs such as (Blind, Deaf and Mute) are given all the support during the time of the examination.
- For example:
 - Blind students are given exams by using the Braille system

- Deaf and Mute students are given reading exams instead of listening, in addition to the availability for a support teacher that can use sign language
- Decentralized internal examinations are done for students with minor learning difficulties, marginal intelligence and slow learners

➤ **Quality of education:**

The Kingdom of Bahrain's focus was on ensuring the quality of education, and there were many projects and bodies capable of achieving this quality, including:

- The “Improving Schools Performance” project in 2008, which contributed to improving the quality of educational services
- The initiative of His Majesty King Hamad bin Isa Al Khalifa, the great king of the country, may God protect him and protect him, for digital empowerment in 2014 AD To improve the learning process and empower the student digitally.
- The National Project for Quality Education and Training, which set quality standards for all levels and institutions of education.
- The Supreme Council for Higher Education and the “National Authority for Qualifications and Quality Assurance of Education and Training” were established in 2008 AD to implement the National Qualifications Framework to classify qualifications according to a set of high standards according to educational outcomes. The work of the Education and Training Quality Authority directly contributes to achieving the fourth goal, which is “Education Good”, through its keenness to ensure equitable and comprehensive quality education for all and to enhance lifelong learning opportunities for all, through:
 - Reviewing the performance of educational and training institutions, the national examination system, and the national qualifications framework.
 - Establishing a culture of creativity and lifelong learning.
 - Creating the features of a citizen capable of contributing to the knowledge economy and qualified to keep pace with the country’s development plans.
 - Ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills necessary to support sustainable development, sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, and the promotion of a culture of peace, tolerance, global citizenship, appreciation of cultural diversity and appreciation of the contribution of culture to sustainable development, by 2030 AD.

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education

- Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation¹³, and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply):

For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b¹⁴

☐ Legal texts¹⁵ prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education:

- ☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- ☒ In primary education
- ☒ In secondary education
- ☒ In technical and vocational education and training
- ☒ In higher education
- ☒ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please indicate the relevant legal provisions:

Measures taken to prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the Kingdom of Bahrain:

The Kingdom of Bahrain is absolutely committed to human rights. Considering the right to education, like all human rights, imposes on the state three levels of duties, namely respect, protection, and entitlement, which we see in various laws of the Kingdom, such as the Constitution, the National Action Charter, and the Education Law, where the right to education is considered one of the basic rights that has been implemented. The Kingdom of Bahrain for consecrating and implementing it in reality and in practice:

- **Article 7 of the Constitution: The state guarantees educational services, imposes compulsory and compulsory education, guarantees the institutions of knowledge and sanctifies them.**
- **Chapter One - Paragraph Eight of the National Action Charter; State guarantee of educational services, imposition of compulsory and compulsory education, state guarantee of academic freedom....**
- **Education Law: Article 1 - Compulsory age: The state guarantees the right to education when the child reaches the age of six according to the Gregorian date of the child's birth, and the compulsory age ends when he reaches the age of fifteen.**
- **Article Two/Article Three (points 4, 5, 6 and 8)**

Commitment to these laws is clear in practical application, Article 8 of the Education Law, which imposes penalties on anyone who violates compulsory education.

¹³ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

¹⁴ Which calls on states to "substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes".

¹⁵ Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc.

Education in the Kingdom of Bahrain is fair and comprehensive, and this is represented by:

- Its inclusion “for all citizens” (Article 2 of the Education Law), “providing educational opportunities for every individual.”
- “Encouraging private education to contribute to the spread of education within the framework of the Kingdom’s general policy” ... “Diversifying educational opportunities according to the diverse individual needs of students.
- “Basic and secondary education shall be free in the Kingdom’s schools.” (Article 6 of the Education Law).
- “Eradication of illiteracy and adult education is a national responsibility whose goal is to raise the level of citizens culturally, socially, and professionally. The Ministry is responsible for implementing the necessary plans to eradicate illiteracy.” (Article 9 of the Education Law).
- The Corona “Covid-19” pandemic also represented an occasion to reveal justice in the Kingdom of Bahrain, as educational services were not affected by the pandemic and the Kingdom made great efforts to continue promoting the right to education for all its beneficiaries, children of citizens and residents.

- Please list the prohibited grounds of discrimination in education as laid out in legal texts:

Attached:

Law No. (27) of 2005 regarding the Education Services

☐ Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education

- ☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- ☒ In primary education
- ☒ In secondary education
- ☒ In technical and vocational education and training
- ☒ In higher education
- ☒ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

Attached:

Law No. (27) of 2005 regarding the Education Services

☐ Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum:

- ☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)

- ☐ In primary education
- ☐ In secondary education
- ☐ In technical and vocational education and training
- ☐ In higher education
- ☐ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

Education in the Kingdom of Bahrain is based on the diversification of human rights of all forms of training, as the training subject on basic human rights is considered one of the subjects within the educational system, and it is independent and covers all levels at all education levels, in government education and private education as well as technical education, The values, interpretive principles, and human rights are among the horizontal values that are embedded in all other subjects.

Represents "the awareness of all groups, especially the emerging generations of man", and the rejection of identifying his origins from the establishment that has:

1. Citizenship and human rights education curricula for various educational levels:

In primary education: Teaching citizenship education aims to train the learner to understand the rules of coexistence to form the self and belong to school life while introducing him to the principles of the political system and social systems. This stage is characterized by the emphasis of teaching on the formation of the learner's self within the school group, that is, the emergence of what can be called the contract through discussion, negotiation, and compromise as conditions for integration. The stage continues by teaching the learner the values of awareness of responsibility by searching for a balance between what he must accomplish, what he can accomplish, and what he is prevented from doing. At this stage, the elements of belonging begin to be taught, such as the national flag, the royal anthem, identification of the national geographic region, some historical monuments, traffic rules, and environmental rules.

In intermediate education: Citizenship education focuses on teaching human rights and duties through acquiring citizenship terms such as freedom, justice, equality, solidarity, and the principles of democracy, knowing political institutions, knowing the basic texts of the political system, and discovering and respecting the basic rules of social and political life.

In secondary education: Citizenship education at this stage focuses on a large part of political education and supporting the culture of human rights for the student who is beginning to prepare to participate in practical life, including political life. Therefore, the emphasis was on citizenship and human rights in:

- Its national dimension in the first stage, by focusing on the principles of national unity, the principles of citizenship in the Kingdom of Bahrain (the principle of equality, the principle of justice, the principle of equal opportunities, tolerance and moderation), and the achievements of the Kingdom of Bahrain in the field of human rights, basic state functions and services, and good governance. In its relationship to public affairs, and the Bahraini political system in particular, with its various components of authorities and the nature of the relationship between them, all of this is within the framework of addressing the development of the student's political and legal culture by addressing the status of women and the position they occupy within the societal scene, including the political scene, as well

as the status of children, and the first With care (people with special needs and the elderly), and supporting the legal, legal and social dimensions of citizenship,

- Its regional and global dimension: by focusing on its conceptual dimensions, principles, and raising awareness of its values and humanitarian dimensions. Citizenship education at this secondary stage also focuses on awareness of the issues of the international community, the importance of its organization and its most important bodies, the importance of adopting peaceful methods to resolve international disputes and disputes, and the importance of international solidarity and cooperation as mechanisms to enhance international peace and security.

2. Extra curriculum the School Enhancing Citizenship and Human Rights Project:

- The School Enhancing Citizenship and Human Rights project comes in implementation of the civilizational, national and civil principles of the reform and modernization project of His Majesty King Hamad bin Isa Al Khalifa, the great monarch of the country, may God protect and preserve him. The project was included within the strategy of the Ministry of Education 2015-2018 AD in continuation of its efforts in developing education for citizenship and human rights. Human rights, enhancing programs and activities related to this subject, and continuing to raise awareness of human rights through general education and training. It has been applied in all primary and middle schools, and work is currently underway to implement it in all secondary schools. The project consists of an integrated package of curricular and extracurricular activities that develop the values, knowledge, skills, and behaviours of citizenship and human rights in the school space.
- The Kingdom of Bahrain's reliance on the approach based on "human rights-based education" has occurred smoothly due to the objective conditions provided for its success, such as training and training on this approach. This approach has also strengthened the culture of human rights in Bahraini society, foremost of which is the work to make More opportunities to obtain education, as the Kingdom of Bahrain was keen to activate the four features (availability, possibility of enrollment, possibility of acceptance, and adaptability) to consider education as an actual right in its laws and educational policies.

☐ Other measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education:

Attached:

Law No. (19) of 2017 regarding the Family law

1.2 Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education

- Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (*several items may be ticked*):

General measures:

- ☒ Legislation provides for inclusive education for all
- ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance inclusion in education for all
- ☒ Teachers are trained on inclusive education¹⁶ and to value diversity
- ☒ Initiatives to address discrimination and promote cultural diversity and mutual acceptance
- ☒ Multiple and flexible learning pathways¹⁷ are provided for
- ☒ Curricula and teaching methods are inclusive in design¹⁸
- ☒ Multilingual and intercultural education is supported
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

The Legislation and policies embedded within the Kingdom of Bahrain’s constitution and the National Action Charter are maintained to ensure effective alignment with the international accords, especially regarding the educational laws and local policies. The Kingdom of Bahrain acceded to the International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination of 1965 but has not ratified the 1960 Convention Against Discrimination in Education, though it has reported to UNESCO in multiple consultations. In parallel, Article 7 of the 2002 Constitution states that ‘The State ... guarantees educational and cultural services to its citizens. Education is compulsory and free in the early stages as specified and provided by law. The necessary plan to combat illiteracy is laid down by law.’

Furthermore, according to the 6th Article of the 2005 Education Law, ‘Basic education is a right of those children who reach the age of six years at the beginning of the academic year. The Kingdom is obliged to provide education for them and their parents or legal guardians are obliged to facilitate this. This shall be for a period of at least nine years of schooling. Accordingly, The Kingdom's Ministry of Education promulgates the requisite laws to govern and uphold the requirement that parents and legal guardians attend their children's school.

- **Integrating students with disabilities (special needs) into fully equipped schools, to ensure that everyone has access to quality education.**

- **MoE provides training programs for all teachers within different aspects to reinforce teaching strategies and cope with new developments in educational field. Training programs are divided into three key categories including educational programs, specialities programs, and support programs.**

¹⁶ Teachers are prepared to teach all student (beyond just students with disabilities), equipping them with knowledge, values and attitudes that permit every student to succeed. See: [UNESCO policy paper: Inclusive teaching: preparing all teachers to teach all students](#), 2020, p.14.

¹⁷ Multiple and flexible learning pathways are ‘entry points and re-entry points at all ages and all educational levels, strengthened links between formal and non-formal structures, and recognition, validation and accreditation of the knowledge, skills and competencies acquired through nonformal and informal education’ ([Education 2030 Framework for Action](#), para. 33). This may include student transfers between courses and institutions and diverse learning modalities (online, in-person, full-time, part-time, etc.) to respond to individual needs and interests.

¹⁸ In designing the curricula and teaching methods, care is given to ensure that all students are provided with an inclusive and supportive learning experience that offers them the opportunity to succeed whatever their background.

MoE has established programs aim to support none native Speakers students and enhance their learning capabilities in Arabic Language within government schools

- In general, what challenges were encountered in the implementation of non-discrimination and equal opportunities principles in education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

none

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☒ Legislation provides for gender equality in education | ☒ All barriers for pregnant girls and young mothers in education are eliminated to ensure the continuity of their education |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance gender equality | ☒ Re-entry programmes for young mothers are provided for |
| ☒ Gender-responsive education sector planning is undertaken | ☒ Ensuring safe and adequate gender-sensitive sanitation facilities ²⁰ |
| ☒ Providing positive or affirmative action measures | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²¹ and bias |
| ☒ Providing financial incentives and fellowships | ☒ Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) |
| ☒ Teachers are trained (initial and in-service) on gender equality | ☒ Ensuring gender parity in technical and vocational training education and training (TVET) |
| ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ¹⁹ | |
| ☒ Other: | |

Pregnant women and mothers

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

The kingdom of Bahrain Constitution ensure gender equality within the educational system, hence equivalent learning opportunities are offered to male and females in Bahrain, as mentioned in the 7th article of the 2002 Constitution 'The State ... guarantees educational and cultural services to its citizens. Education is compulsory and free in the early stages as specified and provided by law'

Gender equality is also evident through the implementation of sustainable development goals within the Kingdom of Bahrain; in alignment with fourth SDG that ensures inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all, Bahrain established a target that state "By 2030, ensure that all girls and boys have access to quality

¹⁹ ' Stigmatisation is the act of treating someone or something unfairly by publicly disapproving of them' (Cambridge Dictionary).

²⁰ ' Gender-sensitive sanitation includes clean, safe and separate toilets, with access to water and garbage disposal' ([UNGEI blog post](#), Gender-sensitive sanitation, 2018)

²¹ Stereotype is a set idea that people have about what someone or something is like, especially an idea that is wrong' (Cambridge Dictionary).

early childhood development, care and pre- primary education so that they are ready for primary education”

MoE established Equal Opportunity Committee in 2016. Government entities formed 45 Equal Opportunity Committees in the government sector following the issuance of Civil Service Bureau Decision No. (4) of 2014 . These committees incorporate women’s needs as a natural part of equal opportunities in all areas of labour, and work towards realizing equal opportunity principles among all employees, beneficiaries, and services in coordination with the Supreme Council for Women (SCW). The committees express their opinions on issues related to the mainstreaming of women’s needs and instituting them as a natural part of the principle of equal opportunity.

Equal Opportunity Committees set controls, standards, and aimed at mainstreaming women’s needs. They follow up on their implementation and provide consultation, in coordination with the Supreme Council for Women (SCW) and the Civil Service Bureau (CSB), if required, and in accordance with CSB specializations as outlined in its rules and regulations for the following areas:

- Promoting equal opportunities between employees in terms of recruitment, training, scholarship, and career advancement, while ensuring the mainstreaming of working women’s needs.
- Mainstreaming of women's needs and creating equal opportunities when it comes to the policies, plans and budgets of government agencies.
- Building the capacities of employees while mainstreaming women’s needs and instituting them as a natural part of the principle of equal opportunity.
- Improving the status of women and their working environments within government organizations and overcoming the obstacles they face.
- Supporting the efforts of the Supreme Council for Women (SCW) in promoting equal opportunity principles and the integration of women's needs into government entities’ programs according to the National Plan for the Advancement of Bahraini Women.
- Achieving equal opportunities for all beneficiaries of services provided by government entities.

The Kingdom seeks to eliminate all obstacles facing pregnant women and mothers and enhance women participation in public life by achieving a balance between women's professional and family responsibilities, enhancing their role in society, and adopting a policy that helps women reconcile family responsibilities and work. From this standpoint, the Kingdom adopted the National Plan for the Advancement of Women (2013-2022); that reinforce principle of justice and equal opportunities, and the advancement of sustainable development programs. National laws and legislation also provides pregnant women and mothers a number of rights, such as the right to necessary health care during pregnancy / the right of privacy and confidentiality / non-discrimination / the right of protection from harmful work / the right of breastfeeding break / the right of maternity leave.

- Pregnant women and mothers can undertake evening education classes as MoE provides evening education for students who are unable to study regularly.

- Follow up and address issues related to women and integrate their needs into development programs, to ensure sustainability and effective coordination with the Supreme Council for Women, to implement the National Plan for the Advancement of Bahraini Women, through participation in coordination meetings related to implementing projects related to education with the Supreme Council for Women, and developing plans

and programs to ensure the effectiveness of the role of Bahraini women in development. The Department of Organizations and Committees Affairs coordinates with the authorities to monitor indicators for implementing the National Plan for the Advancement of Bahraini Women, to ensure the achievement of equal opportunities.

- In The Gender Parity Index (GPI) in SDG4 indicators shows that there are equal opportunities in teachers training

- What challenges were encountered in achieving gender equality in and through education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

- Does the legal minimum age for marriage conform to international standards (18 years) ²²:

Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child's right to education as they are more likely to drop out of school and children who are not in school are more likely to get married.

☐ Yes ☒ No

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate the exceptions to the legal age of marriage as well as the absolute minimum age:

According to Law No. 19 of 2017, the marriage age in the Kingdom of Bahrain is 16 years, except that the Ministry of Education provides evening education for students who are unable to study regularly.

Education is compulsory in the Kingdom of Bahrain from the age of 6 to 15 years, as previously mentioned.

According to the decree-law (25) for 1998, adult learning is available for all Bahraini citizens who are not enrolled in any educational institution, also according to the law (25) Article (9), the law stipulates that "literacy and adult education is a national responsibility whose goal is to raise the level of awareness within citizens culturally, socially, and professionally and to eliminate illiteracy through different programs.

The Ministry of Education offers a variety of types of learning options to pursue continuing education such as basic education, evening schooling, etc

Evening education is designed for people who did not complete their education within all educational levels, it is set to eliminate literacy in the Kingdom of Bahrain. All married

women can join and study in evening education and complete their secondary certificate with no age limitation in joining evening education or online learning.

National minorities:

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities.

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Legislation provides for the right to education of national minorities | ☐ Teachers are trained on intercultural education |
| ☐ Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of national minorities | ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ²⁴ |
| ☐ Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities | ☐ Multilingual and intercultural education are supported |
| ☐ The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for national minorities | ☐ Native language instruction is ensured for national minorities |
| ☐ Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by national minorities | ☐ Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for national minorities |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for national minorities | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²⁵ and bias |
| ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for national minorities | |
| ☐ Other ²³ : | |

It does not apply to the Kingdom of Bahrain

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Article (18) of the Constitution of the Kingdom of Bahrain states: "People are equal in humanity and dignity, all citizens are equal by law in general rights and duties, without discrimination between them on the basis of gender, origin, language, religion or belief." Education Law No. 27 of 2005 stipulates that citizens in the Kingdom are equal in all educational services. The Kingdom of Bahrain rejects the term National minorities and all citizens are equal in all services, including education.

Islamic Subject is not compulsory for non-Muslims, MoE provides support programs for non-native students, such as the Arabic language teaching program for non-native speakers, as well as implementing workshops and training courses, and providing special educational materials.

²³ Please see: [UNESCO report](#) 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023.

²⁴ Supra note 15.

²⁵ Supra note 16.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of minorities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

No challenges

Indigenous people:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Legislation provides for the right to education of indigenous people | ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for indigenous people |
| ☐ Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of indigenous people | ☐ Teachers are trained on intercultural education |
| ☐ Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities | ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ²⁶ |
| ☐ The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for indigenous people | ☐ Multilingual and intercultural education are supported |
| ☐ Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by indigenous people | ☐ Native language instruction is ensured |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for indigenous people | ☐ Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for indigenous people |
| ☐ Other: | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²⁷ and bias |

It does not apply to the Kingdom of Bahrain

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of indigenous people? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

None

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations²⁸:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Legislation provides for their right to education | ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for |
|--|--|

²⁶ Supra note 15.

²⁷ Supra note 16.

²⁸ 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' ([UNESCO report](#): The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2).

- ☐ Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education
 - ☐ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured
 - ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for
 - ☐ All administrative barriers to access education are removed
 - ☐ Alternative administrative procedures (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.) to overcome administrative barriers²⁹ are provided for
 - ☐ Teachers are specifically trained to ensure their inclusion
 - ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation³⁰
 - ☐ Other:
- ☐ Auxiliary assistance is provided
 - ☐ Multiple and flexible learning pathways³¹ are provided
 - ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes³² and bias
 - ☐ Accelerated learning programmes are provided
 - ☐ Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes are provided
 - ☐ Language classes to newcomers are provided for
 - ☐ Multilingualism and intercultural education are encouraged

It does not apply to the Kingdom of Bahrain

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- Have specific measures been adopted for climate displaced persons?

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please elaborate:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of migrants, refugees, asylum seekers, stateless persons and IDPs? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

No challenges

²⁹ While lack of documentation (such as identity papers, birth certificates, residency permits, etc.) should not be an obstacle to access education, these can constitute a barrier to education See: [UNESCO publication](#): Handbook on the right to education, 2018, p. 96.

³⁰ Supra note 15.

³¹ Supra note 13

³² Supra note 16.

People with disabilities

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Legislation provides for their right to education | ☐ Mainstream teachers are specifically trained on disabilities |
| ☐ Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education | ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ³³ |
| ☐ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured | ☐ Auxiliary assistance is provided |
| ☐ Special schools are used as resource centers to inclusive schools | ☐ Curricula and teaching and learning methods are adapted |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ³⁴ and bias |
| ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided | ☐ Education infrastructure and learning materials are adapted |
| ☐ Other | |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

The Constitution of the Kingdom of Bahrain stipulates ensuring educational services for all groups, and the Education Law stipulates in Article Five, First Paragraph, “Providing educational opportunities for every individual to develop his aptitudes, abilities, and skills to achieve self-actualization and develop his life and society.” It was also mentioned in Paragraph (10) of the same Constitution that it is necessary to provide a variety of educational opportunities based on the diverse needs of individuals, caring for gifted and talented students, and enhancing their experiences, and caring for slow learners and people with special needs.

**Ministry of Education initiative to integrate students with disabilities into public schools
Offer people with disabilities special care, providing them with social support, healthcare, and cultural activities, in addition to training and rehabilitation, and helping them to become more integrated into society and the labor market**

Students with special needs are provided with different resources as supplies to support them within the school year, in addition to the support given from the teachers during the examination period.

Students with special needs as (Blind, Deaf and Mute) are given all the support through their school years, and studies to be competent, also the support is given during the time of the examination.

For example:

- **Blind students are given exams by using the Braille system**
- **Deaf and Mute students are given listening exams instead of reading exams, in addition to the availability of sign language teacher for support.**

Reference to Law no. (77) of 2013 Article 31 for salaries and job benefits, an allowance for education, rehabilitation or care of persons with disabilities shall be paid at a rate of (50) or (100) dinars per month to employees performing these tasks in government schools affiliated with the

³³ Supra note 15.

³⁴ Supra note 16.

Ministry of Education and rehabilitation centers affiliated with the Ministry of Social Development.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of people with disabilities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

None

Students from poor households:

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☒ Financial incentives and fellowships for school enrollment are provided | ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ³⁵ |
| ☒ Transport, meals and education material are subsidised or provided free of charge beyond compulsory education | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ³⁶ and bias |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided | |
| ☒ Other: | |

- The Kingdom of Bahrain is one of the first countries in the region to introduce formal education, establishing the first school in 1919. Since then, the Kingdom has ranked first regionally and enjoyed a prestigious position internationally, providing education for every member of society without discrimination. International reports have praised Bahrain's achievements, which is 95%, in addition to its high level in the Human Development Index.
- In line with the "Education for All" principle, the Government provides free, high-quality education at public schools to Bahrainis and expatriates. Students with special needs have been integrated into schools, which have the appropriate equipment, tools, and experience to meet their needs.
- Free transportation services are provided for all students in public schools. More than 37,000 students are transported from their homes in various governorates using 650 buses.
- The Ministry of Education pays particular attention to issues of prejudice and bullying and reducing them in schools. In response to these behaviours, the Ministry has been keen to provide high-quality psychological, behavioural, and social services to all students without discrimination. Lectures and training courses have also been organized to raise awareness among teachers about the issue and how to deal with it.
- The renewal and development of curricula is carried out continuously, in line with local, regional and global changes and developments, including benefiting from modern educational experiences, expertise and practices at the international level. The curricula encourage the inculcation of national, civilizational and human values, such as tolerance, coexistence, moderation, freedom of expression, dialogue and national unity. Special curricula and courses have also been developed to perpetuate these noble national values, such as the community

³⁵ Supra note 15.

³⁶ Supra note 16.

service course, which aims to promote volunteer work, tolerance, coexistence and cooperation among secondary school students.

- The Ministry of “Justice, Islamic Affairs and Waqf” and different Banks provide the Ministry of Education with winter aid coupons to be distributed to the students in need from different governmental schools, which are chosen according to their situation.
- The Ministry of Education provides students that are need with the main necessities as school uniform, shoes, eyeglasses, school stationery, free school transport, and also pocket money (as coupons for the school canteen)
- The Ministry of Education seeks to preserve the psychological well-being of students in need and the underprivileged in the best possible way. The ministry distributes aid vouchers to all students without exception or discrimination, while providing additional support to some needy students through appropriate methods that take into account their psychological circumstances.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- **Law No. (27) of 2005 Regarding Education:** This law is related to education, one of the rights guaranteed by the Kingdom to all citizens. It covers its most important objectives and principles, the bodies responsible for the educational system and its most important tasks, the ages where education is compulsory, the penalty for depriving children of their right to education, the role of the ministry in eliminating illiteracy, the most important basic materials for education, and the number of school day.
- **Aligns with the strategic goals of the Ministry of Education in:**
 - **Axis:** (Improving the quality and efficiency of educational services).
 - **Goal:** (Qualitative curricula that meet the requirements of the 21st century and the Economic Vision 2030).
 - **Goal:** (Educational opportunities available to all).
 - **The goal of providing quality and comprehensive education and enhancing learning opportunities for all in line with Bahrain's Economic Vision 2030.**

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of students from poor households? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

- **Learning disruption due to COVID-19:** To overcome this challenge, 9920 laptops were distributed to students from low-income families.

2. Progress made with respect to implementing the right to education across all levels and forms of education

2.1 Early childhood care and education

For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation³⁷ and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education³⁸. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (*several items may be ticked*):

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are free | ☒ ECCE services respect a child’s need for early cognitive and social development, foundational learning, responsive care, nutrition, health, safety, protection, and play. |
| ☒ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are affordable | |
| ☒ ECCE services are accessible on a non-discriminatory basis | |

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

1. **The cost of enrollment in ECCE institutions varies, which allows most children from different financial group to join.**
2. **The ministry decision and laws mentioned below, guarantee the child’s right to education and none discrimination, and ensure the appropriate environment for education:**
 - **Law 25 of 1998 - private educational and training institutions and related ministerial decisions.**
 - **Law 37 Of 2012 - Child and related ministerial decision for nurseries**
 - **Ministerial decisions 11 of 2014 - establishing nurseries**
 - **Regulatory framework for independent early education institutions**

- Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available?

- ☐ Pre-primary education is compulsory. Please provide the age of enrollment and duration:

- ☒ Pre-primary education is **not** compulsory.

³⁷ Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”.
³⁸ Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE”

- ☐ Pre-primary education is free of charge for all. Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is free:

- ☒ Pre-primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrollment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Law 25 of 1998 - ministerial decision 2 of 1998 - article 10 (to not increase tuition fees, or any other fees without Ministry of Education approval)

Approximate fees range (independent nurseries, and kindergartens)

- **Tuition fees (yearly)**
 - Kindergartens: 200BD - 2000BD
 - Nurseries 100BD - 3000 BD
- **School supplies (Yearly)**
 - Kindergarten: 10BD - 200BD
 - Nurseries: 20BD - 100BD

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Limited access | ☐ Poor learning outcomes |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☒ Low number of professionally trained educators |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | ☒ Lack of support to families |
| ☐ Other: | |

1. Early childhood education is not compulsory

2. Early childhood education is not free and there is no financial support for families

To solve challenges:

Early childhood education, licensing, and follow-up directorate Worked on the following projects:

1. Currently collaborating with UNESCO to achieve the following:

- **ECCE regulatory framework revised and developed**
- **Disability inclusion ECCE, national framework developed**
- **ECCE curriculum framework for ages 3 - 5 developed**

- System management and governance (quality assurance)

2. Finished project recently (road map for Early Childhood Education affordability and accessibility in Bahrain) with consultation company (Arthur D. Little)
3. Insurance or ECCE, Regulatory framework
4. Early intervention for children or special needs proposal
5. Cooperated with QuadraBay to verify the validity of academic qualification, issued by higher education institutions

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

2.2 Primary and secondary education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide “12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory.”

Primary education

- Please provide the age of enrollment and duration of primary education:

- Basic education, covering the first nine academic years for students aged approximately between 6 and 14, is mandatory in Bahrain by law. The Ministry of Education ensures that all children in this age group receive appropriate education, either in public or private schools.
- The elementary level teaches the students the basics of education. Aged from around 6 to 11 years, the students are required to pass two cycles, each consisting of three years.

- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge?

- ☒ Primary education is compulsory
- ☐ Primary education is **not** compulsory.
- ☒ Primary education is free of charge.
- ☐ Primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrollment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Law No. (27) of 2005 Regarding Education: This law is related to education, one of the rights guaranteed by the Kingdom to all citizens. It covers its most important objectives and principles, the bodies responsible for the educational system and its most important tasks, the ages where education is compulsory, the penalty for depriving children of their right to education, the role of the ministry in eliminating illiteracy, the most important basic materials for education, and the number of school day

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Limited access | ☐ Poor learning outcomes in: |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | Foundation literacy |
| ☐ High dropout rates | Numeracy |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | Social and emotional learning |
| ☐ Other: | Others |
| | ☐ Disparity in learning outcomes |
| | ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers |

There are no challenges facing learning in primary schools.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

In the Kingdom of Bahrain, the realization of primary education has been achieved with remarkable success, as there are no significant challenges encountered. The government's commitment to providing free and compulsory education has played a pivotal role in ensuring access to primary education for all children. The establishment of government schools, coupled with the implementation of comprehensive educational policies, has created a conducive environment for quality learning. The seamless provision of free textbooks and transportation services further eliminates potential barriers that could hinder children's enrollment and participation. The absence of challenges in realizing primary education reflects Bahrain's dedication to creating an inclusive and accessible education system.

Secondary education

In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training.

- Please provide the age of enrollment and duration of lower secondary education:

- **Basic education, covering the first nine academic years for students aged approximately between 6 and 14, is mandatory in Bahrain by law. The Ministry of Education ensures that all children in this age group receive appropriate education, either in public or private schools.**
- **This level Known as “intermediate level” is for children usually aged between 12 and 14. Students can only enter this level after successfully completing their elementary education. The intermediate level is taught by teachers specialized in individual subjects.**

- Please provide the age of enrollment and duration of upper secondary education:

- . They are followed by another three years of secondary education, which includes various tracks.
- The final level of school education, the secondary level, prepares students for enrollment in universities and higher institutes, or to directly enter the labour market. Lasting three academic years, it is divided into six semesters. To be accepted into the first semester of secondary education, students are required to have graduated from intermediate school or have an equivalent certificate.

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge?

- ☒ Lower secondary education is compulsory.
- ☐ Lower secondary education is **not** compulsory.
- ☒ Lower secondary education is free of charge.
- ☐ Lower secondary education is **not** free of charge.
- ☐ Upper secondary education is compulsory.
- ☒ Upper secondary education is **not** compulsory.
- ☒ Upper secondary education is free of charge
- ☐ Upper secondary education is **not** free of charge.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrollment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Law No. (27) of 2005 Regarding Education: This law is related to education, one of the rights guaranteed by the Kingdom to all citizens. It covers its most important objectives and principles, the bodies responsible for the educational system and its most important tasks, the ages where education is compulsory, the penalty for depriving children of their right to education, the role of the ministry in eliminating illiteracy, the most important basic materials for education, and the number of school day.

- Please indicate whether the legal minimum age for employment is aligned with the end of compulsory education:

For reference: The employment laws and those related to compulsory education are interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.

Yes ☒ No ☐

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate how the provision is enforced:

- **Law No. (27) of 2005 Regarding Education**
- **Law No. (1) of 2012 Approval of International Convention No. (138) of 1973 on the Minimum Age for Admission to Employment.**
- **Labor Law No. (36) of 2012 for Private Sector**

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☒ Limited access | ☒ Poor learning outcomes |
| ☒ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Low readiness of primary graduates |
| ☒ High dropout rates | ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers |
| ☒ Poor quality programmes | |

☒ Other:

- **Increasing the number of students transferring from private schools to public schools, which requires increasing the number of school seats in public schools by 2,400 seats for the academic year.**

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

- **Students in a yearly basis are transferring from private schools to public schools due to changes in the social status of the families or the income**
- **Regarding the increase numbers of transferred students, the schools do take into consideration the number of chairs that the class can accommodate and that the students are having the full classroom experience without being full occupied**
- **Students in a yearly basis are transferring from private schools to public schools because of the quality of education provided in public schools. This may be influenced by factors such as improved facilities, enhanced educational programs, dedicated teaching staff, or a supportive learning environment. The Ministry of Education continues to work towards further improving the quality of public schools to provide excellent education opportunities for all students, regardless of their background or circumstances.**

2.3 Higher education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3³⁹, and target 4.4⁴⁰. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural

³⁹ Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”.

⁴⁰ Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”.

Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training.

- Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (*several items may be ticked*):

- ☐ Higher education is free of charge
- ☒ Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity (as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience)
- ☒ Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures
- ☒ Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states
- ☒ Higher education allows for multiple and flexible learning pathways (flexible entry and re-entry, recognition, validation, and accreditation of knowledge and skills acquired through non-formal and informal education).
- ☐ Other:

1. Public Higher Education is Subsidized by the Government by Almost 90%:

- Government subsidies covering nearly 90% of the costs for University of Bahrain, Bahrain Polytechnic and Shaikh Abdullah Ben Khaled College for Islamic Studies significantly enhance accessibility for students. By substantially reducing tuition fees, these subsidies make higher education more affordable and attainable for individuals from diverse economic backgrounds. This financial support helps to eliminate barriers that might otherwise prevent students from pursuing higher education, thereby increasing enrollment rates and promoting broader participation in academic programs.

2. The Framework of the Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) has been Initiated (Resolution No. (1) of 2023):

- The initiation of the Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) framework under Resolution No. (1) of 2023 improves accessibility by formally acknowledging and accrediting skills and knowledge gained outside traditional educational environments. Resolution No. (1) allowed individuals to gain access to academic programs at higher education institutions based on their previous work experience.
- Resolution No. (1) of 2023 also allowed progression from vocational streams to academic streams that enhances educational accessibility by providing a flexible pathway for individuals to advance their studies. Students who begin their education in vocational programs can transition to academic programs if they wish to pursue further education. This flexibility ensures that those with practical skills and vocational training have the opportunity to obtain academic qualifications, broadening their career options and supporting their long-term educational goals.

3. Arrangements between the Higher Education Council and Ministry of Interior to provide education to inmates different academic opportunities:

- The arrangements between the Higher Education Council and the Ministry of Interior are poised to offer inmates access to different degree programs provided by both public and private universities. This initiative introduces a range of academic opportunities within correctional facilities, aiming to support inmates' academic and personal development and improve their reintegration into society. The programs utilizes the resources and expertise of various institutions to enhance rehabilitation efforts.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrollment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, university supplies, transport, accommodation). Brief quantitative information may be added.

1. **Legislative Decree No. (3) of 2005 regarding the Law of Higher Education and No. (31) of 2020 amending some provisions of the Legislative Decree No. (3).**
2. **Decision No. (206) of 2023 on Organizing the Work of Private Higher Education Institutions:**
[RBHEC20623.pdf \(legalaffairs.gov.bh\)](#)
3. **Resolution No. (1) of (2023): Transfer of students between HEIs or continuing their studies to obtain a higher academic degree; Students are allowed, according to the decision, to transfer from vocational programmes to academic programmes in accordance to specific requirements.**
4. **Details on entry requirements and tuition fees at the University of Bahrain can be found via the links:**
[JOIN UOB - University of Bahrain](#)
[University Fee Support – University of Bahrain \(uob.edu.bh\)](#)
[STUDYING FEES - University of Bahrain \(uob.edu.bh\)](#)
[No-Poverty Policy – University of Bahrain \(uob.edu.bh\)](#)
5. **Details on tuition fees at Bahrain Polytechnic can be found via the link:**
[Student Fees and Finance - Bahrain Polytechnic](#)

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Limited access | ☐ Low number of professionally trained professors |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Insufficient mechanisms to ensure smooth transition from secondary to tertiary |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | |
| ☐ Poor learning outcomes | |
| ☒ Other: | |

Globalization and Competition: With higher education becoming more global, institutions face increased competition from universities worldwide. This could affect the rate of

international students choosing to study in the higher education institutions in the Kingdom, which could consequently affect the international educational indicators, and be a challenge to enriching our students exposure to multiple cultural background and exchanges.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

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2.4 Adult education and alternative learning

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.”

- Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked):

- ☒ Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education
- ☒ Provision of literacy programmes
- ☒ Provision of continuous learning (such as learning programmes to develop knowledge, skills, abilities, or competencies for personal and professional development)
- ☒ Provision of free of charge learning opportunities
 - ☐ Provision of professional training including reskilling and upskilling programmes
- ☒ Recognition, validation and certification of non-formal and informal learning
- ☒ Provision of free of charge career guidance and counselling
 - ☐ Lifelong learning entitlements including learning accounts, vouchers, etc.
 - ☐ Other:

Providing learning resource centres.

Provision of parallel secondary education

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

Providing education to students imprisoned in criminal cases. According to law no (18) 2014, during the execution of any of the sanctions or measures provided for in this Law, children

shall have the right to pursue their education at different levels of education, in accordance with the regulations and procedures issued by Reform and Rehabilitation Institutions.

According to the decree-law (25) for 1998, adult learning is available for all citizens who are not enrolled in any educational institution, also according to the law (25) Article (9), the law stipulates that "literacy and adult education is a national responsibility whose goal is to raise the level of awareness within citizens culturally, socially, and professionally and to eliminate illiteracy through different programs.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Limited access | ☐ Limited funding |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Poor learning outcomes |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | ☐ Low number of professionally trained educators |
| ☐ Other: | |

Motivating adults to continue education.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3. Quality education provision and learning environment

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2, 4(b) and 5(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for quality education. Quality education is fundamental to achieve all targets of SDG4. It is also particularly highlighted in SDG target 4.a that recommends states to "build and upgrade education facilities that are child, disability and gender sensitive and provide safe, non-violent, inclusive and effective learning environments for all".

3.1 General measures

- Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding:

- ☒ State monitoring and inspections
- ☒ Health and sanitation
- ☒ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))
- ☒ Infrastructure
- ☒ Curriculum
- ☒ Student-teacher ratio
- ☐ School fees (if relevant)
- ☐ Other

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

You may include information on policies, protocols or codes of conduct.

Attached:

- Early education committee report form
- Special Education Committee form
- Technical notes report

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Non-supportive or inadequate learning environments | ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials |
| ☐ Violence in schools | ☐ Inadequate parental support to education |
| ☐ Cost of education | ☐ Long distances to schools |
| ☐ Conflicts or crises | |
| ☐ Other: | |

No challenges

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.2 Education personnel

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked):

- ☒ Teacher training is provided without discrimination.
- ☒ Teachers' average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels).
- ☒ Initial training and continuous professional development are provided.
- ☒ Minimum standards and qualifications required for the teaching profession.
- ☒

Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession.

☒ Measures taken to promote diversity in the teaching workforce, including to redress gender imbalances at different levels of education.

☒ Establishment of performance monitoring systems.

☒ Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education.

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

Teacher's training is provided without discrimination.

- Human resource directorate provides multiple training programs for all categories in the ministry of education and for all nationalities without discrimination in different fields.

Teachers average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels).

- Teachers average salaries are competitive compared to other professions, as it increased based on the budget according to CSB rules & regulations.

Initial training and continuous professional development are provided.

- Human resource directorate provides programs in cooperation with Bahrain teachers college. It is a special program to get a certificate in education, special education, and advanced programs in leadership.

Minimum standards and qualifications required for the teaching profession.

- For minimum standards and qualifications required for teaching profession, applicants who apply for teacher position must hold B.A in Specific major depending on the needs, as some majors are not required, or the capacity may need either male or female in certain majors.

Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession.

- There are many measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of teaching profession, such as graduates from Bahrain Teacher College are immediately employed in teaching position with grade 4, many competitions are held for effective teaching practices and recently the Ministry of Education won the Informatics Index on Instagram Platform.

Measures taken to promote diversity in the teaching workforce, including to redress gender imbalance at different levels of education.

- With regards to diversity in teaching workforce, chances for employment are equal for both male and female, except to some technical majors, males, and females.

Establishment of performance monitoring systems.

- To monitor performance system, HR provides a performance indicator for the quarter half and full year for each employee.

Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education.

- There are many women who take the leads in many events and are willing and ready for leadership positions in education, and this is clearly shown by the huge number of females applying for leadership positions each year.
- Women leadership in numbers: In terms of women leadership, a total of 141 headmaster females in schools compared to 67 males, in addition to 221 headmaster assistance females to 139 of males up to date.

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel?

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☒ Shortages of teaching staff | ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials |
| ☐ Lack of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff | ☐ High student – teacher ratio |
| ☐ Lack of training centres | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

- In the Kingdom of Bahrain, the rising preference for government schools among students and parents, particularly in the early education stages, as well as the shift from private to public education, poses an annual challenge for the Ministry of Education in ensuring the availability of highly qualified, trained, and motivated teaching staff. To address this issue, the Ministry of Education in Bahrain has been implementing various solutions, such as increasing investments in the development of educational infrastructure to create a stimulating learning environment equipped with modern technologies. Additionally, continuous training programs for educators are being offered to enhance their teaching skills and interactive techniques, thus meeting the evolving demands of the education sector.
- The human resource department provides programs in cooperation with Bahrain Teachers college, It is a special program to get a certificate in education, special education, and advanced programs in leadership.

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.⁴¹ Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1.

- Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked):

- ☒ Curriculum includes human rights education.
- ☒ Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education.
- ☐ Other:

- **The integration and promotion of the values of belonging and citizenship in the curricula and building the national character, noting that the ministry has made quantitative and qualitative improvements to the curricula to promote respect for the law, opinion and other opinions, build and implement the school model that promotes citizenship and human rights according to international standards, and develop curricula for all school levels under the name of citizenship education.**
- **Activating the role of the school in raising respect for the principles of citizenship and human rights, promoting the values of coexistence, tolerance, moderation and non-violence, and strengthening the national, Gulf and Arab dimensions of the Bahraini identity.**
- **Achieving international standards in the development of study programs and textbooks, and employing information and communication technologies, teaching practices, evaluation methods, school environment and school time.**
- **Meeting the learning needs of all students in dedication to the principles of justice and lifelong learning.**
- **Refer to the SDG4 indicators, specifically target 4.7: and which is concerned with the extent to which global citizenship and education for sustainable development are mainstreamed in national education policies, curricula, teacher education and student assessment, the Kingdom of Bahrain has achieved first place in the Arab countries in achieving this indicator.**

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

- **Based on the directives of His Majesty King Hamad bin Isa Al Khalifa to teach the political system to secondary school students and what is stipulated in the Constitution of the Kingdom of Bahrain in Article (7-B) and the Education Law on the teaching of national education; In response to that, Ministerial Decision No. 252/ME/2004 was issued on 18/04/2004, and the Ministry of Education and Training decided to teach citizenship education as an independent subject in**

⁴¹

Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”.

general education and began applying experimental books since 2005. (Ministerial Decision No. 252/ME/2004 dated 18/04/2004).

- Within the framework of continuous development, a Memorandum of Understanding was signed with the International Bureau of Education in January 2012 for a period of 5 years. The memorandum covers several areas, including reviewing the curriculum to guide it towards strengthening competencies in the fields of learning, life, and work, values of citizenship, human rights, and sustainable development, and implementing activities in the field of promoting citizenship and human rights. This cooperation resulted in the adoption of the guiding framework for citizenship education and human rights by the International Bureau of Education.
- A Pioneering Experience in the Field of Citizenship and Human Rights Education Within the Framework of the "Enhanced Citizenship and Human Rights School" Project.
- The Enhanced Citizenship and Human Rights Schools project was launched in four government preparatory schools as a pilot phase ending at the end of the 2016-2017 academic year. The project aims to expand the scope and develop opportunities for raising students in the Kingdom of Bahrain schools with comprehensive civic education that promotes values of responsible citizenship and cultivates peaceful coexistence and respect for diversity and difference. In particular, it aims to transform the school into a framework for civic coexistence that enhances:
 - Embracing the values of national loyalty and belonging, tolerance, and moderation.
 - Commitment to national unity.
 - Pride in the Gulf character, Arab identity, Islamic civilization, and human values.
 - Mastering dialogue, self-management, and peaceful problem-solving skills.

The project includes various aspects, including classroom and non-classroom activities that have been influenced by the curricula and have also influenced them in order to achieve the desired goals.

The 122 UNESCO ASPnet schools in the Kingdom of Bahrain, encompassing both government and private institutions across all educational levels, including kindergartens, are committed to delivering quality education to every student to fulfill the network's mission. United by a vision focused on advancing peace, love, justice, and development, these schools aim to instill these core values in students, fostering a generation that embraces these principles and recognizes their importance in education. Aligned with His Majesty the King's Reform Project, the National Action Charter, and the Constitution, the schools actively involve students in both curricular and extracurricular activities that educate them about global issues and the United Nations' role in addressing them, all while promoting the values of peace, human rights, coexistence and dialogue.

3.4 Non-state actors in education

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision⁴².

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked):

☐ Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation⁴³ explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. Please specify:

⁴² Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors.

⁴³ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

The right to education is a guaranteed right for all. The amended Constitution of the Kingdom of Bahrain states in Article No. (18) thereof that: “People are equal in human dignity and citizens are equal before the law in public rights and duties. There shall be no discrimination among them on the basis of gender, origin, language, religion or creed”.

☐ Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). [Please specify:](#)

Non-state education supplements public education and does not supplant it. According to Law No. (27) of 2005, the right to education is guaranteed by the Kingdom to all its citizens. However, non-state schools (almost 80 in the Kingdom of Bahrain) offer a variety of international and national curriculums which meet the different needs and expectations of citizens and residents, therefore those schools offer parents and students a choice and a relevant alternative to public education.

☐ Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. [Please specify:](#)

The Ministry of Education teaches Islamic education curricula in public and private schools for Bahrainis, whatever their beliefs and without discrimination. Such curricula include a set of principles and values that are common to religions and sects, such as virtues, ethical and behavioural values, harmony, human solidarity, and tolerance among human beings. Studying the curriculum of Islamic education is not compulsory on non-Muslims (Bahraini or foreign), nor is it counted as part of their exams and assessments.

The Kingdom of Bahrain has special interest and given great care and attention to the right to education, as it is considered a guarantee to enable and strengthen the practice of all related human rights and in particular cultural rights. The amended Constitution of the Kingdom of Bahrain stipulates in Article No. (7) thereof, that: “a. The State sponsors the sciences, humanities and arts, and encourages scientific research. The State also guarantees educational and cultural services to its citizens. Education is compulsory and free in the early stages as specified and provided by the law. The necessary plan to combat illiteracy is laid down by law. b. The law regulates care for religious and national instruction in the various stages and forms of education, and at all stages is concerned to develop the citizen's personality and his pride in his Arabism. c. Individuals and bodies may establish private schools and universities under the supervision of the State and in accordance with the law. d. The State guarantees the inviolability of the places of learning”.

Article 22 of the Private Educational and Training Institutions Decree-Law No. (25) of 1998 states “A foreign private educational institution shall comply with the curricula, books, and hours approved by the Ministry in relation to the Arabic language syllabuses prescribed for Bahraini students and Arab students and in respect of Islamic religious culture for Muslim students if the institution accepts them, and in respect of the history and geography of the State of Bahrain for all students, as part of the school timetable and without changing additional fees. The following should be complied with in determining such curricula...”

☐ Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. [Please specify what is covered:](#)

- ☒ Registration
- ☒ State monitoring and inspections
- ☒ Qualifications of teachers
- ☒ Health and sanitation
- ☒ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))
- ☒ Infrastructure
- ☒ Curriculum
- ☐ Student-teacher ratio
- ☒ School fees
- ☒ School closures
- ☐ Other

Infrastructure:

According to Article 10 of Decree No. 25 of 1998 with regards to Private Educational institutions:

1. A private educational or training institution shall have independent headquarters fulfilling the hygienic, educational and occupational safety conditions and standards that shall be specified in an order to be issued by the Minister.
2. No building can be constructed or private educational or training premises are used, or new facilities added without the Ministry's approval.
3. The headquarters of a private educational or training institution may not be transferred without the Ministry's approval.

Curriculum: The following articles of Decree No. 25 of 1998 with regards to Private Educational institutions:

Article 21

The private national educational institution shall observe the following:

1. Teach the prescribed curriculum used at the government schools in Arabic language, Islamic education and social studies at the primary, intermediate and secondary levels.
2. The academic year shall not be less than 180 days.

Article 22

A foreign private educational institution shall comply with the curricula, books, and hours approved by the Ministry in relation to the Arabic language syllabuses prescribed for Bahraini students and Arab students and in respect of Islamic religious culture for Muslim students if the institution accepts them, and in respect of the history and geography of the State of Bahrain for all students, as part of the school timetable and without changing additional fees. The following should be complied with in determining such curricula:

1. Public interest and the interest of Arab, Muslim and foreign students in the State of Bahrain.

2. The system followed in evaluating academic achievement of students in the foregoing subjects.

School fees: The following articles of Decree No. 25 of 1998 with regards to Private Educational institutions:

Article 16

A private educational or training institution shall comply with the fees charged to students or trainees, as approved by the Ministry, and they may not be altered except after the approval of the concerned Ministry.

Article 17

The revenues of a private educational or training institution shall be deposited with one of the commercial banks operating in the State of Bahrain in a special account in the institution's name.

Article 18

Except for nursery schools, a private educational and training institution shall appoint a firm of auditors to examine its annual accounts, and it shall forward a copy of its audited annual accounts to the concerned Ministry.

Qualifications of teachers: According to Article 12 of Decree No. 25 of 1998 with regards to Private Educational institutions:

Private educational or training institution shall have a teaching or training staff, and the following conditions must be satisfied by whoever is employed as a teacher or instructor therein.

1. He must have the appropriate qualifications and experience as determined by the Minister.
2. He must enjoy his full legal qualifications, reputed for his good conduct, and that no conviction should have been issued against him in a felony or misdemeanor affecting his honor, integrity or public morals.
3. The Ministry must have approved his employment, and such approval should be renewed once every two years for non-Bahrainis.

Private schools in Bahrain cater to different needs and beliefs, for example Sacred Heart School which was established in 1948 is currently in the care of the Apostolic Carmel Sisters and is permitted to have Sundays off out of respect for the majority of the faculty's and students' religious practice in contrary to other schools where the week typically starts on Sunday, the large South Asian communities' needs are met through many schools serving them (around 13 schools) such as the Indian School and Pakistan School, even though most of the private schools in the Kingdom are co-ed , single-gender schools are also available such as Al Iman Schools and Al Falah Schools as well as Shaikha Hessa Girls' School.

- Please elaborate:

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision?

- ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials
- ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers
- ☐ High student – teacher ratio
- ☒ Other:
- ☐ Issues in terms of equity and inclusion
- ☐ Weak government regulatory and monitoring capacity

establishment of new institutions with affordable fees

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

A main challenge is the establishment of new institutions with high quality education and affordable fees for a wide section of the population. The demand on current mid- range fee schools is high and most new investors request a higher fee range to acquire a better return on investment and to maintain international accreditation standards.

3.5 Digital education

Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion⁴⁴.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked):

- ☐ Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework.

Please indicate the relevant text and provisions:

Empowering all students, as well as educational and administrative bodies, to benefit from the educational and information and communication technology services provided by the eduNET educational portal and Microsoft 365 accounts, including the Microsoft Teams application. This integration into teaching and learning processes is designed to equip students with the knowledge and skills necessary to enhance their academic achievement and personal development. By providing appropriate digital educational content and necessary support, the policy ensures effective, safe, and guided synchronous and asynchronous learning, thereby sustaining the continuity of education.

- ☐ Core legislations, policies, strategies or plans for the management, privacy, security, storage, transfer, use, and sharing of education data internally and externally to ensure the right to privacy of learners and education stakeholders (e.g., informed consent, transparent usage policies, etc.)

- ☒ Regulatory framework establishes minimum education standards for digital education to which all actors in education must comply.

⁴⁴ Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment.

- Measures to remove barriers to accessing digital content⁴⁵, including ensuring access to curriculum-aligned digital content available on free, public, multi-modal national platforms; high-quality content is available in core subjects, official national language(s), and designed with inclusive features to assist learners with disabilities.
- Digital skills incorporated into pre- and in-service teacher and leadership training curricula to create a culture of digital innovation and growth anchored in equity and inclusion that enables ongoing professional development for existing and emerging staff.
- Future-ready skills (including digital skills, data and AI competencies, critical thinking, etc.) integrated into formal curriculum at all levels of education
- Measures address the digital divide, including ensuring access to reliable electricity, meaningful internet connectivity at school and at home, devices suitable for learning and teaching, safe and sustainable software and secure platforms, and integrated education data systems.
- A well-established, sustainable, and cost-effective budget secured from a range of funding sources and intersectoral cooperation, supported by impact focused reporting linked to regional strategic goals.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

A regulatory framework has been established for digital education standards that all parties in the field of education must adhere to this has been accomplished through the development of regulatory policies for each area of digital empowerment in education. Digital empowerment serves as an extension of King Hamad's Schools of the Future project.

This was accomplished by providing access to digital educational content through two core services, "My Digital Library" initiative and the educational portal eduNET.

My Digital Library Initiative: The My Digital Library initiative is a key component of the Ministry of Education's digital empowerment efforts in education. This initiative emphasizes the creation of digital educational content by both teachers and students, ensuring that this content is accessible and shared as Open Educational Resources (OER). By evaluating and adopting digital content based on specific criteria, indicators, and policies, the initiative aims to maintain high standards of educational and technological quality. The approved content is then published on the My Digital Library website, making it available for the broader educational community to benefit from.

The objectives of the My Digital Library initiative are as follows:

- 1. To publish schools' exemplary digital educational content on the "My Digital Library" website, following specific guidelines and policies, to maximize its benefit.**
- 2. To equip teachers and students with the skills needed to produce high-quality digital educational content that meets approved standards.**
- 3. To implement a policy with established standards and indicators for evaluating digital educational content produced by schools, ensuring its quality from both educational and technical perspectives.**

⁴⁵ Lack of internet connection, basic infrastructure or devices.

4. To strengthen the role of schools in sharing and disseminating their digital educational content.

Here are the links related to the My Digital Library initiative:

- **My Digital Library Management System:** This system is exclusively accessible to residents, who must log in with a unique username and password. The My Digital Library Management System can be accessed at the following link:

[<http://moedu.gov.bh/MyDigitalLibraryCMS/>] (<http://moedu.gov.bh/MyDigitalLibraryCMS/>)

- **My Digital Library Website:** Visitors do not need a username or password to view all published digital educational content. The My Digital Library website can be accessed at:

[<https://moedu.gov.bh/MyDigitalLibrary/>] (<https://moedu.gov.bh/MyDigitalLibrary/>)

****My Digital Library Site Usage Policy: ****

1. The author and source of the content must be properly cited, as with any printed material.
2. Content posted on the site may not be used for commercial purposes; this means that neither the content nor products incorporating the content can be sold.
3. Schools are responsible for all content they publish.
4. Each user or publisher must select the appropriate Creative Commons license for their content.
5. It is prohibited to publish content that is scientifically inaccurate or that discriminates based on religion, gender, race, or language.
6. No advertising or promotional content is allowed within the produced content.
7. The site assumes no legal responsibility for any content published, including errors, defamation, omissions, or inaccuracies in the posted information.

eduNET Educational Portal: The eduNET Educational Portal is a national e-learning platform designed to support digital empowerment in education. It serves as a communication bridge between the Ministry of Education's student databases and its various audiences, including students across all educational levels, administrative and educational staff in government schools, and parents. The portal provides a range of administrative and educational electronic services, such as displaying student grades, academic schedules, tracking daily attendance and absences, monitoring daily assignments, and more. These services benefit students, teachers, specialists, school administrators, and parents, while also adhering to strict information security standards.

The portal is also available as a mobile application, allowing parents to conveniently access information about their children, such as attendance records and academic results, directly from their smartphones. Additionally, the educational portal offers easy access to digital educational content, including electronic lessons, resources, and enrichment software for subjects like science and mathematics. This content includes interactive simulation software that helps students engage with various educational objectives, such as solving mathematical problems or conducting scientific experiments on their own.

To access the portal, users must enter their username and password at the following link: [\[www.edunet.bh\]\(http://www.edunet.bh\)](http://www.edunet.bh).

Digital Empowerment in Education Program: This program incorporates digital skills into the on-the-job training of teachers and administrators to support continuous professional development. Additionally, it provides targeted training programs for newly joined educators and administrators in the field.

The Digital Empowerment in Education Program is designed to enhance educators' ability to integrate digital tools and technologies into their teaching practices. The program provides a wide range of training options, from basic to advanced levels, covering the effective use of smart devices, document cameras, and interactive whiteboards. Specialized workshops focus on digital exams, simulation systems, augmented reality (AR) tools, and hologram technology. Educators also receive training on innovative tools such as QR codes, digital games like "Blooket," and virtual reality using Unity 3D. The program offers certifications in Microsoft tools and concepts, including Minecraft Education Edition, Microsoft Teams, and Microsoft Forms, which are crucial for modern classroom management and hybrid learning approaches. Overall, these programs aim to empower educators to create engaging, interactive, and digitally enriched learning environments

Safe Use of Technology: This initiative focuses on empowering students, parents, and educators to use technology in a positive, safe, legal, and ethical manner. It aims to develop digital citizens who can adapt to and thrive amidst technological advancements and innovations. The program offers training for students, teachers, and IT specialists on strategies, solutions, programs, and systems to prevent and mitigate risks associated with technology use. It emphasizes guidance and education through a comprehensive training package and various educational activities, fostering a safe and informed approach to technology.

- AI Implementation in Education: The Ministry of Education has proactively established a comprehensive policy and implementation plan for integrating Artificial Intelligence (AI) into the educational system, based on both national and international standards. This initiative is informed by the latest scientific and academic research in AI, ensuring alignment with global advancements and best practices. The policy includes a strategic framework for developing tailored training programs that equip educators with the knowledge and skills to effectively incorporate AI tools into the classroom. These programs are designed to enhance educators' understanding of AI technologies and their applications, promote innovative teaching methods, and prepare students for a future where AI and other future technological skills, such as critical thinking, play a central role in the learning process

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Lack of quality, curriculum-aligned digital teaching and learning content that supports flexible learning and teaching pathways | ☐ Limited access to internet and/or electricity |
| ☐ Lack of equity and inclusion in digital learning solutions | ☐ Limited access to hardware (devices, chargers, etc.) |
| ☐ Inadequate safety measures and IT support to respond to issues of child online safety or reduce cyber security risks | ☐ Difficulty in regulating the use of digital education solutions |
| ☐ Other: | ☐ Difficulty in sustainably financing digital education solutions at national scale |

- ☐ Lack of digital skills development for meaningful use of digital technology in teaching practice
- ☐ Disjointed or fragmented solutions that are not centrally systematized or regulated

No challenges were encountered in digital education provision

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

4 Strengthening governance systems

For reference: The Education 2030 Framework for Action states "to ensure quality education and conditions for effective education outcomes, governments should strengthen education systems by instituting and improving appropriate, effective and inclusive governance and accountability mechanisms; quality assurance; management information systems; transparent and effective financing procedures and mechanisms; and institutional management arrangements, as well as ensure that robust, timely and accessible data are available" (para. 18).

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked):

☒ Monitoring mechanisms to assess compliance with the right to education obligations, including through management information systems.

☐ Monitoring results are made public. Please provide the link:

☒ Monitoring processes are participatory, inclusive and regular.

☒ Sector-wide and multisector approach is adopted to education governance.

☒ Financial resources are effectively allocated to prioritise the provision of free, quality, public education and are adequately budgeted for in government plans.

☒ The decision-making process for the allocation of resources to education is transparent.

☒ Ensuring crisis-sensitive and disaster risk-informed planning and programming, including the provision of quality education in emergencies.

☐ There is a certain degree of decentralization in favour of local public authorities and autonomy for schools to ensure context relevance of their teaching.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

- compulsory to provide education to those in the basic education stage from 6 to 15 years. The Compulsory Educations section at the Ministry of Education follows up on the registration of Bahraini children in public and private schools, to ensure that everyone has registered in schools, and follows up on studies and not just registration. The department also makes continuous efforts and effective coordination with the Information and e-Government Authority to count the numbers of children who have reached the compulsory age and have not yet reached the compulsory age. They enrollment in the first grade of primary school, at the start of school each year, through electronic data. The numbers of adults who are not registered in schools are counted, and the relevant authorities are addressed to find out the reasons for their non-enrollment, and we strive to ensure that each student achieves his right to education, through coordination with the departments, The competent authorities, parents and other relevant parties. This follow-up continues until the child reaches the age of 15 years, by monitoring those who have dropped out of education for 10 or more school days, continuous or separate, with an unacceptable excuse. A follow-up system and forms have been prepared.
- The Kingdom of Bahrain allocates budget to various ministries to cover operational costs, implementation of development projects and programmes. MoE plans and allocates budget for educational and digital infrastructure and other educational projects based on the Ministry of Education's assessment of needs and requirements.
- The Ministry of Education has worked towards developing a systematic framework with a time plan to manage and resist risks and with no reactions. The best methods and procedures are employed to reduce negative effects and address them according to scientific and methodological foundations. Additionally, the risk management and sustainability report is issued every two years. Ministry of Education employees are trained on the procedures to follow during emergencies, ensuring the Ministry is well-prepared to handle disasters and crises effectively.
- The Kingdom of Bahrain is considered one of the leading countries in applying modern administrative foundations and principles, through the Cabinet decision issued in September 2011 regarding “obligating government agencies and companies to implement governance systems and procedures”, this was followed by the issuance of the “Government of Government Institutions” guide in May 2013, which is a reference for applying the principles and foundations of governance to all government institutions. Accordingly, the Ministry of Education issued the “Governance Guide in the Ministry of Education”, where tasks were distributed to the relevant departments in the ministry, and they are monitored through the government performance monitoring system to monitor the desired objectives of implementing governance tasks and what was implemented to achieve the principles of governance and prepare annual reports on achievements.

- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance?

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Budgetary constraints | ☐ Absence of supportive/ inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment |
| ☐ Lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels | ☐ Lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data |
| ☐ Poor dialogue with teachers’ trade unions | |

☐ Other:

No challenges

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

III. Methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments

For reference: UNESCO governing bodies have underlined the need for awareness raising. Given the importance of normative action at the national level, wide dissemination of the Convention must be ensured, with the support of National Commissions for UNESCO.

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked)

- ☐ Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages
- ☐ Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education including through appropriate materials and resources
- ☐ Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments
- ☐ Other:

Non

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